

he takes up the story of Neh. he describes the death of Ezra at an advanced age (*ib.* § 5). Jos. follows Esd. as his authority, so that the testimony is emphatic on this negative point—that Ezra and Neh. were not contemporaries. Further Jos. says that both Ezra and Neh. flourished in the reign of Xerxes (485–464), and he relates that the death of Joakim the high pr. took place at about the same time as that of Ezra. Now Joakim was the son of Jes. (Ne. 12¹⁰), and he might have ruled in the time of Xerxes, but he could hardly survive till the reign of Art. As Jos. followed his sources pretty closely, it is perfectly possible that the date of Ezra in the original text of Esd. was the reign of Xerxes, and that Art. is one of the many modifications in that text based on MT. As the version of Esd. lost favour largely owing to Jer.'s great influence (*cf.* ES.¹³), there was an evident effort to recover its lost prestige by eliminating its variations from MT. Such a date for Ezra is not impossible, esp. when the scope of his mission is properly limited. He must be separated from Neh. by a considerable space of time.

Such evidence as we have in our sources, however, points to the conclusion that Ezra followed Neh. To that evidence we now turn.

In Ezra's prayer he refers to God's grace as manifested before his time, and among other evidences cites "the giving of a wall [in Judah and] in Jerus." (Ezr. 9⁸). As shown in the notes, the reference can only be to the wall built by Neh. We are told that Ezra went into the chamber of Jehohanan the son of Eliashib to spend the night (Ezr. 10⁶). The succession of high pr. in Ne. 12²² shows that Jehohanan is identical with Jonathan (12¹¹) and that he was the grandson of Eliashib (so *Sta. Gesch.* ii.¹⁵³). Now as Eliashib was a contemporary of Neh., Ezra is two generations later, or exactly where he belongs, in the reign of Art. II. Neh.'s administration began in 444, and Ezra's in 397 or later. Finally in Ne. 12²⁸ we have the order "Neh. the governor and Ezra the pr., the scribe," and these are not contemporaries, but belong to successive periods. It does not help, therefore, to correct the text of Ezr. 7¹, as proposed by We. (*Gesch.*^{169,n}), reading 27th instead of 7th. Indeed, that would make matters worse, for as Neh. was governor of Judah from the 20th to the 32d years of Art., we should then have Ezra coming up in the very midst of Neh.'s rule. It is certainly simpler to suppose that the reference is to Art. II.

These considerations fix the date of Neh. as that of the reign of Art. I (Longimanus), 464–424. Torrey insists that "the tradition represented by the Aram. document and the Chr." places Neh.'s work in the reign of Art. II (Mnemon), 404–358 B.C., and says that we have no means of determining which Art. was the benefactor of Neh. (*Comp.*⁶⁵, ES.³³⁶). This conclusion comes from taking Chr.'s arrangement too seriously. Ezra could hardly have been later than Art. II, and I have shown that he followed Neh. Moreover, Neh. must have